



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Twin Peaks Classical Academy

School Website: <https://twinpeaksclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Twin Peaks Classical Academy (Longmont, CO; 80501) presents a robust classical orientation across multiple domains, anchored by a charter-school model and a teacher-led, standards-aligned program that centers on truth, beauty, and goodness. Public materials emphasize character formation, a liberal-arts-inflected approach (grammar, logic, and rhetoric), and a strong parental partnership. Overall, the school reads as CLASSICAL, with strong alignment in Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents/Community, and clear but partial alignment in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and Pedagogy. The executive snapshot below details category-by-category signals, supported by explicit textual evidence from the school's site and the classical-education rubric.

Key takeaways - The school foregrounds truth, beauty, and goodness, and highlights character formation (Six Pillars of Character) as core aims. These align with the classical formation mindset, though explicit theology and liturgical practices are not evident in the public materials. **Category signals:** Religious and Metaphysical Foundations – SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; School Purpose & Goal – CLASSICAL. - **Evidence:** Our Values / Vision emphasizes truth, beauty, and goodness; presence of character formation and teacher-led instruction; Latin is described as central to classical education. - Curriculum and pedagogy show strong classical markers (grammar, logic, rhetoric; liberal-arts orientation; engagement with great works; emphasis on memory and recall in lower grades). However, explicit upper-level Socratic seminars or a fully developed Great-Books/Great-Conversation emphasis is not overtly documented in public pages. **Category signals:** Curriculum – CLASSICAL; Pedagogy – SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - **Evidence:** Text references to grammar/logic/rhetoric; emphasis on great works and primary sources; Core Knowledge framing; lower-school emphasis on memory and songs. - Faculty and leadership material present a teacher-led, mentorship-oriented culture with defined leadership, which aligns with classical expectations of “the living curriculum” and faculty as exemplars. **Category signals:** Faculty – CLASSICAL. - **Evidence:** Leadership profiles and teacher emphasis in public pages; explicit teacher-led classroom orientation. - Parents and Community are clearly positioned as partners and co-educators with a parent-governed structure and proactive family engagement. **Category signals:** Parents & Community – CLASSICAL. - **Evidence:** “Twin Peaks is a Parent-Governed School”; parent participation expectations; open campus openness and community emphasis.

Executive summary – Category-by-category snapshot - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Overall aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

What follows is the category-by-category analysis, including keyword extraction, positive/negative keyword indicator alignment, and the rationale for each category rating. A concluding section titled What Would Move the Needle outlines concrete steps that would push the school toward a fully CLASSICAL designation where needed.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials highlight the pursuit of truth, beauty, and goodness as central aims and describe character formation as foundational. This aligns with transcendental realism in classical education, even if explicit theology or liturgical practices are not foregrounded in the visible content. See Our Values / Vision and related statements about forming character and seeking truth, beauty, and goodness. - Explicit theology, liturgical practices, or sacramental/communal worship are not clearly documented in the publicly accessible pages provided, which suggests partial alignment rather than full integration of theological/liturgical elements. For example, the site emphasizes a public-charter, teacher-led approach and character formation rather than liturgical life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present on public materials include: truth, goodness, beauty (plus references to virtue via the Six Pillars of Character). The lexicon for this category explicitly flags these transcendental terms as positive indicators. In the site content, truth, beauty, and goodness appear explicitly in the Vision statement, which aligns with the Positive Keywords. 3 explicit terms observed: truth, goodness, beauty. - Negative keywords (e.g., secularism, relativism, values-neutral) do not appear overtly in the public-facing materials for this dimension, indicating no clear signaling of the negative indicators in the visible materials. The absence of overt secular or relativist language reinforces a partial alignment rather than a fully theologically grounded model.

Why this rating - The school explicitly embraces transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue-centered formation, which aligns with Transcendental moral realism. However, explicit grounding in theology or liturgical/community practices is not clearly documented in the publicly available pages. The presence of non-theological classical motifs (literature, core knowledge, and character formation) yields a category of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL in this dimension.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Vision emphasizes seeking truth, beauty, and goodness as guiding aims for character formation, not merely information transfer. The school frames education as formation of virtue and human excellence, consistent with classical telos. It also notes the public-charter mission and preparation for higher education, reflecting human excellence and a long-game orientation. - The presence of “Six Pillars of Character” and a focus on virtue and moral imagination signals a formation-first orientation aligned with classical aims. The site communicates a mission oriented toward character formation and human flourishing rather than purely job-readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, classical heritage. The lexicon’s Positive Keywords for this category enumerates formation; virtue; liberal education; classical mission; pursuit of the true, good, beautiful; scholé (contemplation/rest). The school’s stated aims map to formation and virtue, with explicit mention of truth/goodness/beauty in the Vision. 4–5 positive cues observed: formation, virtue, wisdom (via character formation references), truth/beauty/goodness (explicit in Vision). - Negative keywords (e.g., college/career readiness as sole teleology or workforce prep emphasis) are not strongly signaled as the school centers on formation and virtue rather than a narrow job-prep track. The public materials emphasize a broader classical telos rather than a purely instrumental aim.

Why this rating - The school articulates formation, virtue, wisdom, and pursuit of transcendent aims (truth, goodness, beauty). The emphasis on a liberal-arts formation and classical heritage supports CLASSICAL more strongly than mere SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, given the alignment with foundational classical spirituality-oriented goals (telos and human excellence) rather than a purely secular, modern job-prep trajectory.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes a curriculum rooted in classical education concepts, including the role of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, and a curriculum oriented toward reading great works and cultural literacy. Public materials emphasize the Threefold structure of classical education and a content-rich approach (Core Knowledge, study of great works, primary sources, and historical emphasis). The presence of Latin as central to classical education is explicitly noted. - The materials describe a content-rich curriculum that emphasizes reading foundational texts and historical documents, with a core emphasis on a liberal-arts framework and Great Books-like orientation (great works of literature; primary sources). The Core Knowledge framing is also cited as a curricular backbone.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books / great conversation (via references to great works of literature and primary sources); history across disciplines; Latin central to the curriculum; core knowledge sequence; integration with a liberal-arts orientation. These keywords align with the document's Positive Keywords for Curriculum (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Cross-disciplinary integration; Integration and Wonder). Examples drawn from site materials include explicit mentions of grammar/logic/rhetoric and historic-literary engagement. - Negative keywords (e.g., "project-based learning dominance" or "STEM-first framing") are not evidenced in the school's public materials; rather, the site emphasizes a traditional, great-books-and-grammar logic, which does not signal anti-classical approaches. The absence of these negative signals reinforces alignment with classical curricular ideals.

Why this rating - The curriculum is described with explicit classical signposts (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books/literature; history emphasis; Latin centrality) and a strong emphasis on foundational liberal-arts content. While the site does not present a verbatim "Great Conversation" label in every public page, the textual framing around Great Books, primary sources, and cultural literacy maps well to classical curricular criteria. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes a teacher-led classroom model and a strong emphasis on character formation, with lower-level content that includes singing, memory, and recitation elements (e.g., preschool singing and memory-driven activities). The public materials emphasize classroom structures as teacher-led rather than student-directed. This aligns with the classical emphasis on teacher-guided instruction and memory work in early years. Preschool materials explicitly reference nursery rhymes, songs, and memory-based activities as part of foundational learning. - Explicit upper-school Socratic seminars, debates, or rhetoric-training opportunities are not clearly documented in the available public pages. The classical-pedagogy rubric values Socratic discourse and formal rhetoric in upper grades, which is not strongly evidenced in the visible site content. The publicly visible pages emphasize teacher-led instruction and foundational classical pedagogy rather than a consistent, high-frequency Socratic/seminar approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present include: teacher-led classroom; memory work; singing/memory in lower grades; engagement with great works of literature; classical pedagogy signals (grammar/logic/rhetoric). The Lexicon for Pedagogy lists Socratic seminars, narration, and rhetoric training as classic features; the site has some alignment but not a consistent high-frequency depiction of Socratic seminars. Positive signals: teacher-led, memory/recitation-like practices in early years; mention of classic texts and memory-based learning. - Negative indicators appear to be minimal in public materials; there is limited evidence of modern, project-based, or student-centered, highly autonomous pedagogy in the publicly visible materials. The absence of heavy emphasis on experiential/project-based learning as the primary mode signals a partial alignment rather than full alignment with the more expansive "pedagogy" indicators. The absence of explicit Socratic seminars in public pages yields a weaker alignment with the strongest classical pedagogy signals.

Why this rating - The pedagogy leans toward classical (teacher-led instruction with memory-based learning in early grades) but lacks explicit, consistently documented Socratic, seminars, and rhetoric-learning at high

school levels in the publicly visible content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation, with room to strengthen upper-grade Socratic and speech-rhetoric pedagogy in publicly available materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a multi-level leadership structure (Executive Director, Elementary Principal, Secondary Principals, etc.), with staff biographies that emphasize teachers' backgrounds, commitment to classical education, and role in guiding students. This aligns with the classical expectation that faculty are mentors and exemplars who illuminate the curriculum. The leadership pages present a professional, mission-driven faculty with backgrounds in classical education approaches. - Additional evidence of a community of educators and mentors appears in the site's emphasis on teacher-led classrooms, long-tenured leadership engagement, and the emphasis on staff as part of a collective "community of learners." The public materials describe teacher-led instruction and a long-running, parent-governed school context, which supports a living-curriculum orientation often associated with classical faculties.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: teachers as mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; teachers as exemplars (as described in the classical lexicon). The Lexicon lists terms like "model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge" and "the living curriculum" as positive indicators for Faculty. The school's public leadership pages show dedicated faculty leadership and teacher-focused statements, aligning with these positive indicators. - While the site does not use every classical-lexicon phrase, the explicit emphasis on teacher-led classrooms, mentorship, and faculty profiles aligns well with classical expectations for faculty. The presence of formal leadership (Executive Director, principals, etc.) reinforces professional, mission-focused faculty culture.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials position faculty as formal leaders and mentors within a teacher-led, classical framework, which aligns strongly with the classical vision of faculty as exemplars and the living curriculum. This yields CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes parental partnership and governance: "Twin Peaks is a Parent-Governed School," with parents identified as the child's first teachers and active participation in committees and governance. The site also notes the importance of parent involvement in committees, volunteering, and school life, signaling a robust parental-role alignment with classical education. - The culture of community engagement is reinforced by references to a long-standing parent-led mission, boards, and active family involvement with policy and curriculum decisions. The materials repeatedly foreground parents as co-educators and essential stakeholders. - Public pages also highlight continued engagement with families (open campus, tours, and family-focused events) that supports a strong home-school partnership, a hallmark of the classical education ecosystem.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present include: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, family involvement, home-school collaboration, open campus, parent formation, and classical family culture. The classical-lexicon set lists these partner-and-community signals as strong positive indicators for Parents & Community. The school's public materials provide direct statements about parent governance and involvement. - Negative keywords (e.g., "customer" language, minimal parental involvement) are not evident in the school's public-facing content; the site consistently presents a high level of parental involvement and governance.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a clear, explicit, and sustained emphasis on parent involvement, co-governance, and community partnership, aligning strongly with classical expectations for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Introduce explicit theology or liturgical/community practices in publicly accessible materials, or provide a clearly labeled pathway showing how faith perspectives inform core curriculum and character formation. This would strengthen the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices signals and convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL into CLASSICAL in this category.
 - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Expand explicit upper-grade (9–12) Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discussions, or rhetoric-focused projects, and document these practices on public pages to strengthen the Pedagogy dimension from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
 - Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) alignment: More explicit articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation as a structured, school-wide curricular thread across grades (K–12) and align upper-grade instruction with consistent Socratic dialogue and evidence of rhetoric training, to deepen the programmatic alignment with classical ideals.
 - Element 2 (Purpose and Goal) and Element 5 (Faculty) emphasis: Continue to articulate and document explicit markers of moral formation (virtue ethics, character formation in the faculty living curriculum) and maintain a visible, public-facing portrait of teacher-mentors with evidence of ongoing faculty formation in classical pedagogy.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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